WRENFORD BOROUGH COUNCIL

Statement Guide: Hazard

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1. What this guide covers

This guide covers hazard: the danger a defect puts people in before anything has happened - cyclists swerving into traffic, people tripping, water hiding a hole, branches striking people walking, a dark footway or a column that could fall. It appears in resident descriptions and call notes, and in the notes of an earlier inspection.

The guide is used by the Street Care Coordinator or Highways Inspector who opens a review - the reviewer in this guide - and by the Highways Inspector who decides it. Whether a requirement is met is a separate question, settled by the report and its defect type's own standard. This guide is about what the documents show: the tools flag only a measurement sentence whose figure differs from the report's or gives a figure the report left blank, as the Report Rules set out, and every other check here is the reviewer's own.

2. How it shows up in a statement

A sentence of this kind usually says one of these:

- who could be hurt, and how
- drivers or cyclists swerving or braking
- people with pushchairs, wheelchairs or walking sticks forced into the road
- a defect hard to see in the wet or in the shade
- a danger to anyone using the street

3. What the reviewer checks

These are the checks the reviewer makes, in this order:

1 Read each sentence of this kind for who is at risk and how.

2 Note a hazard to people walking, cyclists or high vehicles.

3 Note a hazard near a school, a bus stop or a crossing.

4 Weigh the hazard in the recommendation without letting it decide a requirement.

5 Note a hazard that the inspection should look at first.

4. Requirements it bears on

Hazard bears on no requirement: it tells the Highways Inspector how urgent the defect is, and the requirements still decide which decisions are open.

5. When the statement and the report disagree

A hazard cannot disagree with a report's answer, because no requirement reads it; where it suggests the defect is worse than the report's figures, the reviewer notes it for the Highways Inspector.

6. What to ask the reporter for

Ask the reporter who uses the street at the defect, and whether anyone has had to swerve, stop or step into the road.

7. Telling it apart

A danger that could happen is a hazard; something that has already happened is an incident, which the Incident guide covers. "Someone could trip on it" is a hazard; "my neighbour tripped on it" is an incident.